Geological time

Student: ..... Class: .....

The geological eras

1. (a) Complete the following table by naming the geological eras. The times for each era are approximate and vary as new data and evidence is collected.

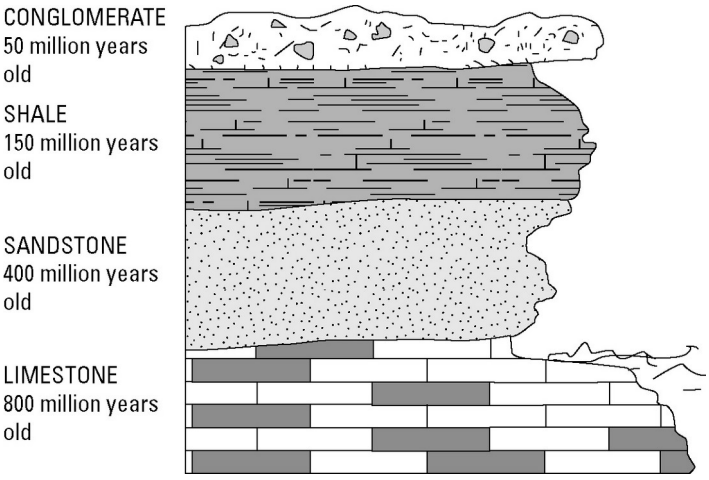
Time (millions of years ago)	0–65	65–245	245–545	545–2500	2500+
Era					

(b) Identify the era in which each of the following events occurred (as revealed by the fossil record).

First birds appear		**Land plants emerge**	
Bacteria first appear		**Humans appear**	
Oxygen-rich atmosphere forms		**Insects appear**	

Fossils and geological time

2. The following sea cliff face has four sedimentary layers that have been dated.



(a) Algal fossils were found in the limestone layer. In which era did these organisms live?

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(b) Explain why a dinosaur fossil could not be found in the sandstone layer.

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(c) Identify which of the following fossils could only be found in the conglomerate layer: amphibians, seed plants, turtles, insects.

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Continents and geological time

3. The following drawing shows the continents as they were 250 million years ago.



(a) The continents were in these positions at the end of which geological era?

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(b) Describe the types of living things that dominated the temperate lands at that time.

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